# GSP 270 Unabridged Syllabus

Welcome to ***Geographic Information Science!*** Sometimes referred to as ***GIScience*** or ***GIS***, this field focuses on the advancement and use of concepts, information, methods, models, and technology for comprehending and interpreting geographic connections, relationships, patterns, and processes. It is a subset of the broader term, Geospatial Science, in that it centers explicitly on geospatial *data* as the topic of research. Research on geographic information includes, but is not limited to the following topics:

- Analytical tools for geospatial data
- Geospatial data display and visualization
- Geospatial data management
- Geospatial data modeling
- Issues related to ethics and privacy
- Methods for geospatial data collection and measurement
- National Spatial Data Infrastructure
- Spatial statistics
- Theories for geospatial data structures, algorithms, and processes
- Uncertainty

## Objectives

After completing this course, students should be able to:

1. Demonstrate an understanding of spatial data types
2. Identify issues related to uncertainty in spatial data
3. Organize and execute a project with a geospatial component
4. Collect and create geospatial data
5. Prepare data for analysis
6. Apply a variety of geospatial analysis, attribute query, and overlay techniques
7. Communicate findings through graphic media and visualization techniques

Cal Poly Humboldt Learning Outcomes: **https://academicprograms.humboldt.edu/content/student-learning-outcomes (https://academicprograms.humboldt.edu/content/student-learning-outcomes)**

## About the Course

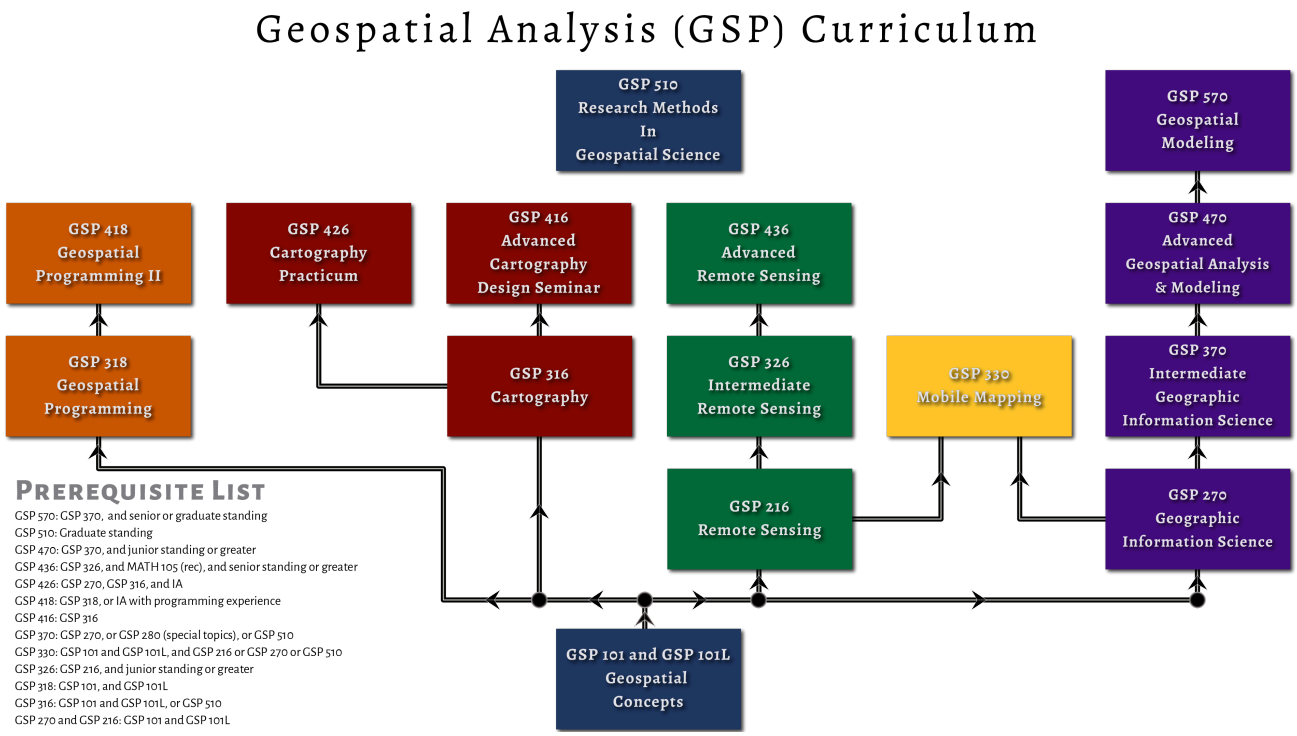
The term GIS is sometimes used to refer to Geographic Information Systems (GIS), which can lead to some confusion about what a course actually covers. While this class relies heavily on Esri software for many of the assignments, this is not a software class, and the focus of the course will be on the underlying concepts and processes of GIScience.

*Geospatial Concepts (GSP 101/GSP 101L)* is the prerequisite for Geographic Information Science. Students are expected to have a solid foundation of both geospatial concepts and experience using GIS software built upon the *Geospatial Concepts* course including but not limited to:

- Projections and Transformations
- Datums
- Geographic and Projected Spatial Reference Systems
- Table Joins
- Adding XY data
- Attribute Queries
- Spatial Queries
- Classification
- Cartographic Design
- GPS Data Collection and Download
- Data Acquisition from Public Sources
- Data Management

The emphasis of the course is an applied geospatial project. The deliverables will include a project lab report. With the project lab report as the ultimate goal, the Geographic Information Science course will introduce range of techniques related to vector and raster analysis. Students will communicate the results of these activities by writing professional lab reports, enabling students to master this skill before delivering the final project report.

This course is the first in the GIScience branch of the Geospatial curriculum at Cal Poly Humboldt:




The course content focuses on the academic, workplace, and industry sector competencies outlined in the **U.S. Department of Labor Geospatial Technology Competency Model (https://www.urisa.org/resources/geospatial-management-competency-model/)** , including:

- Reading
- Writing
- Core Geospatial Abilities and Knowledge
- Working with Tools & Technology
- Planning and Organizing
- Critical & Analytical Thinking
- Creative Thinking
- Problem-solving
- Positioning & Data Acquisition

## Instructor

**Amy Rock, Ph.D., GISP**
amy.rock@humboldt.edu (mailto:amy.rock@humboldt.edu)
Geography, Environment & Spatial Analysis

Dr. Amy Rock is a longtime resident of Ohio, and a (relatively) recent transplant to Northern California, where she teaches geography, GIS and cartography in the Department of

Geography, Environment, and Spatial Analysis at Cal Poly Humboldt. She is also the Executive Director of the **University Consortium for Geographic Information Science (UCGIS)** (http://ucgis.org).

Doc Rock encourages her students to become engaged in their communities and think critically about politics, economic and community development and the role of nonprofit organizations in our society. She works with nonprofits and community organizations to bring geospatial thinking to contemporary issues. An avid map geek, she shamelessly judges a book (or video game) by its map.

- **Email**: Always use your Humboldt email account to contact me, as our spam filters often block Gmail accounts with names similar to university accounts.
- **Office Hours**: This course is conducted entirely online. Office hours will be replaced with email, the Slack forum, or Zoom sessions. General questions about the course format and content should be posted to the Question and Answer discussion forum. Personal matters should be restricted to direct email.

***NOTE: I will read and respond to e-mail and Q&A (Slack) forum posts at least once per day, Monday through Friday.***

## Required Materials

The text for this course is **Essentials of Geographic Information Systems**, by Campbell and Shin. It is free and online at **https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks/textbooks/67** (https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks/textbooks/67). Additional readings will be provided by the instructor.

**Recommended**: Mastering ArcGIS, by Maribeth Price. McGraw-Hill. Great if you like video tutorials for ArcMap. Any edition from 5-7 will suffice.

Also, you may find it helpful to reference the text for GSP 101, ***Geospatial Concepts, 2nd Edition***, by Nicolas Malloy and Amy Rock, ISBN 9798577591878. This textbook is available as a **free PDF** (https://bit.ly/geospatial-concepts-2ed). If you wish to purchase this book in a different format, it is also available at **Amazon,** (https://www.amazon.com/dp/B09CC84SQQ) **Google** (https://play.google.com/store/books/details?id=PHc-EAAAQBAJ), or (https://play.google.com/store/books/details?id=PHc-EAAAQBAJ) **Apple** (http://books.apple.com/us/book/id1582056922).

## Technical Requirements

As this is an online course, you already know you need reliable internet access (broadband or DSL) and a browser installed on your computer. If you encounter problems with their

internet connection while working on this course, it is their responsibility to find an alternative internet access point, such as a public library. The **Chrome** browser is the recommended browser for interacting with the course. Note: Cookies and JavaScript must be enabled. Pop-up blockers should be configured to permit new windows from linked websites. Other browsers, such as Safari, Edge, and Microsoft Explorer are **not recommended** for this course.

The **Virtual Lab (http://vlab.humboldt.edu/)** has everything else you need. The required software is also installed in geospatial computer labs and at the Cal Poly Humboldt Library. Registered students will have full access to the virtual lab with their Humboldt login and password. Be aware that vLab performance is related to your internet speed and connected users, so crunch times, such as Sundays and Finals Week, may be slower than expected.

Students working from personal computers that choose not to use the Virtual Lab are required to install or have access to the following software:

- **7-Zip** (**7-Zip (http://www.7-zip.org/)** is a free, open-source file compression/decompression utility) **Installing 7zip on Windows 10 (https://youtu.be/VnezWqRxwRg)**
- **ArcGIS Pro** (information on installing and licensing the software is in **Module 1 (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/75893/pages/1-dot-1-overview-2)** )
- **Microsoft Office (http://www.bkstr.com/webapp/wcs/stores/servlet/NavigationSearch?searchTerm=microsoft+office&categoryId=&storeId=220405&catalogId=10001&langId=-1&pageSize=40&beginIndex=0&sType=SimpleSearch&resultCatEntryType=2&showResultsPage=true&searchSource=Q&pageView=)**
- **Adobe Acrobat Reader**

Please review the **system requirements (https://pro.arcgis.com/en/pro-app/3.0/get-started/arcgis-pro-system-requirements.htm)** for ArcGIS Pro before making the decision to use your own computer.

## Accessing the Software

We strongly recommend you access the software for this course via the Virtual Lab. Module 1 contains instructions and best practices for working in our virtual environment. Software installed on personal computers will not be supported by the Help Desk.

If you will be working in the field, or other environment with intermittent internet access, please contact your instructor about other methods for acquiring the requisite course software.

## Computers on Campus

Due to on campus courses, lab availability is limited. Please refer to the **ITS Computer Labs (https://its.humboldt.edu/classrooms/labs)** page for information on campus labs. Click on an individual lab to see a calendar of availability. Lab use is also subject to building access hours.

Courses are also taught in these computer labs, so **please be respectful.** Check the schedule posted on the door before entering. **Do not** interrupt an ongoing class. If a course is starting while you are already working, always ask the instructor permission to use the computers if there is a class in session.

## Online Etiquette and Course Communication

Both hybrid and online courses at Humboldt will have a high degree of online content and interaction. Cal Poly Humboldt and the instructor of this course are committed to educational access for everyone. This commitment includes creating a welcoming environment for students from all walks of life. Students are expected to maintain a respectful and professional level of discourse when communicating on discussion boards, email, and assignments. Students should also use caution and good judgment when choosing to disclose any personal information with persons they do not know.

All official communications from the instructor are sent to the student's **Cal Poly Humboldt email accounts**. Be sure to check your Humboldt email account regularly so that you do not miss any critical information.

## Canvas Announcements

From time to time, class announcements will be sent out via the Canvas Learning Management System. It is your responsibility to make sure your **personal settings (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/profile/communication)** in Canvas **are set to receive email notifications** about these announcements.

## How to Write an Email to Your Professor

Understanding how to write an email to your professor may sound obvious. However, with the prevalence of social media and text messaging, many students are unaware of the shift in etiquette that becomes necessary when communicating in a professional manner. When writing an email to professors, it can be disrespectful to send short, cryptic messages that you might use while texting or on social media.

Emails to your professors should include the following:

1. A descriptive subject line that includes your name and your class
2. A proper greeting
3. A detailed explanation of your needs
4. Use appropriate punctuation, capitalization, and grammar (for example: never use a lower case "i" as a personal pronoun).
5. A proper sign-off
6. Suitable self-identification (Your full name).

If you are using a mobile device, such as an iPhone, be sure to change the default settings on your signature line. Remove default signatures such as, "sent from my iPhone," and replace it with your name and major or something more meaningful. To many instructors who see this signature line, coupled with a very terse message, it might give the impression that you are sending them a text message rather than composing a thoughtful email.

Please take the time to read the following article to understand what is and what is not appropriate:

- **Advice for students so they don't sound silly in emails (https://www.google.com/url?sa=t&rct=j&q=&esrc=s&source=web&cd=4&ved=0ahUKEwiTtPWskY_PAhXHSSYKHQsHDu8QFggtMAM&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.insidehighered.com%2Fviews%2F2015%2F04%2F16%2Fadvice-students-so-they-dont-sound-silly-emails-essay&usg=AFQjCNFL3S-2NWohCiwEjgZCZHxCNPm-vA&sig2=BfUpwVOHACpSv2P6byKKFA&bvm=bv.132479545,d.eWE&cad=rja)**

## Online Communication and Etiquette Expectations

The following are the guidelines modeled after the Cal Poly Humboldt **Online Communication and Etiquette Expectations (https://docs.google.com/document/d/1RpfP_yY44wGDoDVsEaawduu8rP39UEqj7loCeZcPx6c/edit)** .

### Be Professional, Clear and Respectful

Clean and efficient writing translates into clear and useful communication. Writing the way you would speak is a good rule of thumb. Use a positive tone and adhere to the same rules you would follow in face-to-face communications. Use proper grammar, spelling, and formatting - checking all communications before sending. Check messages and respond in a prompt manner.

Your professional image is an important part of credibility and all of your communications will factor into the big picture.

## Read and Formulate Communications Carefully

Take the time to think about the information contained in all of your online communications. This time will allow you to consider all points thoughtfully, reduces confusion and prepares you for a valid response. You can in return, research your facts and provide citations for information stated within your communications. This practice promotes a robust academic environment and adds credibility to any course. Re-read all communications before sending to avoid emotional statements and or "all capital letter" text and keep communications meaningful and to the point.

## Be Tolerant and Cooperative

Bear in mind that every student is participating in learning. Anyone can make a simple mistake in research, knowledge or communication. Address the idea/concept, not the person. Keep an open mind and focus on the task at hand - *learning*. When adverse conditions arise, and communications get strained - try to help rather than hinder. Real cooperation means working together to the same end - everyone wants to be successful in any given course.

## Keep it PG-13 and Confidential

Unless the subject matter calls for the use of topics/language that would otherwise override this tip, all online communications should be transmitted with the intent to inform, inspire, etc. - not to offend or breach personal privacy. Keeping your content PG-13 and confidential will ensure that this is the case. Never use private information about other individuals and be sensitive to the information you share about yourself. Avoid the use of slang, jargon or sarcasm - as they can confuse your recipient.

## Remember This Course is Hybrid or Online

If you are taking an online course, your instructor and fellow students may be located around the world or have very different schedules than you do. If you are taking a hybrid course, there may be times when you are required to complete activities outside of class. You may not always receive an immediate response, especially on weekends. Make sure you plan for this and don’t put things off until the last moment.

## Use Proper Headings and Subject Lines

Emails and Discussion Forum topics should have subject lines that reflect the content of your message. “Question on Week 3 assignment feedback” is better than “grades” and “Week 3 Reading is Missing” is better than “Help!”

Provide context for your responses. If you are sending a reply to a message or a posting, be sure you summarize the original at the top of the message. Include just enough text of the original to give a context. This practice will make sure readers understand when they start to read your response. Giving context helps everyone.

### Provide Enough Detail in Your Messages

When asking for help, either from your instructor or technical support, be sure to provide as much information as possible to help resolve the issue. Make sure to include the course name and activity name, what you were attempting to do, the full text of error messages and your browser/version information (if a technical issue), a screenshot displaying the problem, and any other relevant information. It may take a little more time up-front to compose your question, but it can help to eliminate some of the back and forth communication.

## Getting Help

Students are expected to seek answers to questions regularly throughout the semester. Understanding where to post questions or look for existing answers is important.

Typically, there are two ways to obtain answers to questions:

### Slack forums

If the question is **general or related to the course content**, such as assignments, quizzes, class schedule, etc., students are required to use the Slack forums to post questions, rather than emailing the instructor directly. This step is the equivalent of a student raising their hand in a face-to-face class. It will save time, and every student in the course will have a chance to hear both the question and answer.

In the context of peer collaboration and support, students are also welcome to try to answer each other’s questions on the Slack forums.

The instructor will address questions on Slack at least once per day, Monday through Friday.

### Email

It may be tempting to send your instructor an email as soon as you have questions. However, this is not always appropriate. If an issue is related to a **personal or confidential matter**, such as grades, emailing the instructor using your **Humboldt email** via Google Mail is appropriate. If the question is **not confidential**, students should use the **Slack forums**.

Students who consistently ask general questions using email, and not the discussion forums, will be gently reminded to do so by the instructor.

## Troubleshooting and Technical Help

If you encounter technical problems or have questions related to the software, you should seek assistance from the Help Desk. When requesting assistance, please be as detailed as possible about the problem or issue. Include many details and provide a screen capture image.

### Humboldt Technology Help Desk

The **Technology Help Desk (http://www2.humboldt.edu/its/services/help-desk)** can assist with Canvas, Humboldt User account, or password problems. The Help Desk can't provide assistance with problems such as virus infections and other system-level issues relating to student-owned equipment.

## Additional Resources

Students are encouraged to use services such as **Grammarly.com (https://www.grammarly.com/)** to improve the quality of writing assignments. With the free version, students can upload their writing assignments, check the quality of their work, and make corrections before submitting a final draft.

## Campus Learning Resources

The Geospatial Homework Lab is located in Natural Resources 203. When time and budget allow, several students are available throughout the week as *Geospatial Support Assistants*. Information about these and other tutors will be posted on the course homepage.

## Writing and Academic Support

Students are encouraged to take advantage of additional academic resources at Cal Poly Humboldt. In particular, students should seek help with writing assignments and the final project at the **Writing Studio (http://www2.humboldt.edu/learning/writing-studio)**. For additional resources visit the **Learning Center (http://www2.humboldt.edu/learning/)**.

## Student Support Services

Sometimes students need additional support to ensure success and I encourage you to take advantage of these services as needed. The following student services are available at Humboldt:

- **Retention through Academic Mentoring Program (https://www.humboldt.edu/ramp)**
- **Academic & Career Advising Center (http://www2.humboldt.edu/acac/)**
- **Student Disability Resource Center (http://www.humboldt.edu/disability)**
- **Veterans Enrollment & Transition Services (http://www.humboldt.edu/veterans)**
- **Learning Center (http://www.humboldt.edu/learning/)**

## Keys to Success

The online and hybrid versions of this course are offered in a flexible, highly self-reliant format. When compared to traditional courses with a more rigid and structured format, some students may take some time to adjust.

To be successful in this course, students should be self-motivated, detail oriented, computer literate, and have the ability to troubleshoot technical difficulties through the use of search engines, help documentation, and discussion forums. Take the time to carefully read the course syllabus and understand the course requirements.

Before posting new questions on discussion forums, students should first review previous posts to check for solutions. Questions posted should be accurate, detailed, and precise. Take the time to read the course syllabus carefully, understand the course requirements, and review the course orientation material.

## Submit More than the Minimum Work to Get an A

Most assignments will require a minimum amount of work to receive a grade. For example, a writing assignment may require a minimum length of 500 words. Students that only submit the minimum amount of work (between 500 to 600 words in this example) should expect to receive at most a **C** grade. To receive an **A**, students should submit exemplary work that exceeds the minimum requirements by a significant amount.

## Course Load and Hourly Commitment to Study

At Cal Poly Humboldt, a unit represents approximately three hours of work per week. This calculation means that for a 3 unit class in a standard 16-week semester, students should be prepared to spend **9 hours per week** on reading, activities, and study. For the 3 unit, 8-week version of this course, each week of this course represents *two weeks* of a regular semester. Students should be prepared to spend at least **18 hours per week** on reading, activities, and study.

## Course Format and Schedule

**Course Format:** 8-week online (asynchronous)
**Expected Work Load:** The expected workload at Cal Poly Humboldt is calculated at 3 hours per week for each unit in a standard 16-week course, or 9 hours for this course. For the online 8-week course, this amounts to 18 hours per week.
**Credit:** 3 units

This course is offered in a flexible, highly self-reliant format and some students may take time to adjust. GSP 270 is an **asynchronous course**, which means there are no required meeting times. You are free to work on activities at times that best fits your needs, and deadlines are provided to keep you on track. For most assignments, there are no late penalties.

There are some exceptions to the late policy:

- Discussion Forums: Only earn maximum points for posts that are submitted ***before*** the due date. Fewer points are awarded as time goes on. See the discussion rubrics for specific details.
- Final Exam and the Final Project cannot be turned in late.

All late work must be submitted by the **Friday before final exams**. No late work will be accepted after **11:55 pm** on this day.

The complete course schedule can be found via the **Syllabus (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/75893/assignments/syllabus)** or your **Canvas Calendar (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/calendar)**. Any changes will be addressed via Announcements, and dates in Canvas will be adjusted accordingly.

## Modules

This course is organized into weekly modules. You must progress through the modules **sequentially**. Assignments, quizzes, or pages may not be available until you have

completed earlier steps in the module. Requirements might include viewing the previous page, completing a previous assignment, or completing a previous quiz or exam.

You **must complete earlier modules** before you can progress to the next in the module in the series.

> **Note:** Submitting placeholder assignments is not allowed. A student who submits placeholder work to unlock modules will receive a zero grade for that assignment and re-submissions will not be accepted. Multiple instances of submitting fake assignments may result in receiving a **zero grade for all subsequent assignments**.

## Readings

The assigned readings in this course cover a range of geospatial topics. Most readings can be accessed from a variety of devices, although you will need a PDF reader for some of the materials. Refer to the Technical Requirements for specifics.

## Activities

Course activities are designed to reinforce the chapter material through a combination of tutorials, skill drills, writing assignments, and online forum-based discussions.

## Assessments

The assessments in this course will be practical exams in the form of Canvas quizzes. You will be asked to complete certain tasks, and your answers will be submitted via a Canvas quiz. Some assessments, such as the Midterm and Final, will only be available during certain periods, and may not be made up without a legitimate exception, such as military or fire service deployment, mandatory evacuations, or significant medical concerns. If you know you will be without internet access during the Midterm or Final windows, please consult immediately with your instructor about alternatives.

## Discussion Forums

There are discussion forum activities, starting during week one. Some will require research and reading before posting to the forum. Most will also require responses to posts written by other students. In most cases, students must post before seeing other students' posts.

Discussion board activities are graded based on the timeliness and quality of forum posts. Discussion forums will be open for the duration of the course. However, discussion forums have due dates. Posting early on, well before the due date, is encouraged and can earn a few extra credit points. Maximum points are awarded to students who submit a post ***before*** the due date. Fewer points are awarded as time goes on.

## Writing Assignments

Writing assignment often involves some level of research and reading. Some will require applying what students have learned during tutorial activities (see above). Lab reports *must* be turned in as an **MS Word document (.docx) or PDF** file using Humboldt's Canvas system. Other file formats, such as .pages or Google docs, will not be accepted for credit.

### Meeting Minimum Word Count Requirements

Most writing assignments require a certain length and will include a minimum word count. The **main body text** of the document determines the word count calculation. Extra elements, such as a title page, name, date, headers, footers, a table of contents, bibliography, etc., **do not count** towards the final word count calculation. The instructor will make the final determination when calculating the word count for writing assignment submissions.

Writing assignments that do not meet the minimum word count will receive a **0 grade**.

Students may be tempted to submit assignments that do not meet the minimum word count or present work that barely addresses the requirements by a narrow margin. By not meeting the requirements or by skimming the bottom edge of the word count, students risk not receiving credit for their work. To remedy this, students should always expand upon their thoughts and ideas in order to exceed the minimum by a **large safety margin**.

### Student Work Samples

Below are some work samples completed by previous students, in this or other courses. Reviewing work samples helps students to understand the scope, length, and quality of work related to written assignments.

> Note: The examples below are not intended to represent the specific requirements or instructions. Requirements **may change over time**. Always refer to the instructions in

> Canvas when determining the requirements for any assignment.
>
> - **Mapping Flood Elevations (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1OjcZoVuDX4Y83e-NVHOa3WDSd9Egw7I1/view?usp=sharing)**
> - **Mapping Food Deserts in Southern California Counties (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1-kRLHx11M2ijL7iHTEnuQgyZRYSmOcBH/view?usp=sharing)**
> - **Elk Herd Counts in Coastal Del Norte and Northern Humboldt Counties of California (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1mDGT6cUwYLUM75gB3NNlLQnRvYhkYlz0/view?usp=sharing)**

## Academic Honesty

Students **are not allowed** to work together during any quizzes or exams in this course, with the exception of the planning discussion for the midterm. Please keep in mind that the Canvas system logs all student activity, including access time and IP addresses. All work submitted must be your own.

> Evidence of academic dishonesty, **including Canvas logs**, will result in a failing grade in the course.

## Grading and Assessment

Each grade category will be weighted as follows:

- Activities 50%
- Discussions 10%
- Final Project 20%
- Assessments 20%

Canvas will update with any graded assignments as grades are released by the instructor. Late assignments will receive a 0 when the deadline is reached, and will update once graded by the instructor. It is your responsibility to review your grades regularly, and consult with the instructor if you feel there is an error.

Accumulation of weighted point totals at the following percentage levels will be assigned a grade no lower than that indicated in the table below.

Grading Scheme

| Letter Grade | Grade Percentages |
|---|---|

| Letter Grade | Grade Percentages |
|---|---|
| A | > 93.0 % |
| A- | 90.0-92.9 % |
| B+ | 87.0-89.9 % |
| B | 83.0-86.9 % |
| B- | 80.0-82.9 % |
| C+ | 77.0-79.9 % |
| C | 73.0-76.9 % |
| C- | 70.0-72.9 % |
| D+ | 65.0-69.9 % |
| D | 60.0-64.9 % |
| F | <60% |

## Final Project

The purpose of the final project to synthesize the information learned in this course. Students will carry out a mapping project developed in consultation with the instructor. Students will collect a geospatial dataset, either by acquiring data on the internet, or by using a GPS receiver and any other equipment available. Ideally, the mapping project will lay the groundwork for future projects in subsequent geospatial classes. However, this is not a project requirement. Students should try to find two academic journal articles or news articles that relate to your mapping theme.

For example, if your data collection topic centered around shore birds, you may want to find journal articles related to shorebird ecology or news articles related to a recent restoration project. Ideally, you would tie these articles into your project topic using the Introduction section, though you may cite them anywhere in your report.

The final project will be turned in as a research poster suitable for a professional conference.

More details can be found on the **Final Project (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/75893/assignments/619730)** page.

## Meeting Minimum Requirements

Minimum requirements represent the minimum amount of work needed to earn a grade. Students who submit incomplete work, or do not meet the minimum requirements regarding length and content, will be given a zero grade for the assignment.

### Meeting Minimum Word Count Requirements

Most writing assignments require a certain length and will include a minimum word count. The **main body text** of the document determines the word count calculation. Extra elements, such as a title page, name, date, headers, footers, a table of contents, bibliography, etc., **do not count** towards the final word count calculation. The instructor will make the final determination when calculating the word count for writing assignment submissions.

Writing assignments that do not meet the minimum word count will receive a **0 grade**.

Students may be tempted to submit assignments that do not meet the minimum word count or present work that barely addresses the requirements by a narrow margin. By not meeting the requirements or by skimming the bottom edge of the word count, students risk not receiving credit for their work. To remedy this, students should always expand upon their thoughts and ideas to exceed the minimum by a **large safety margin**.

For more information, review the section *Submit More than the Minimum Work to Get an A* under *Keys to Success*.

## Policy on Generative AI

Generative artificial intelligence (AI) programs, such as ChatGPT, may be used in this course to brainstorm or learn more about a topic, revise your work, draft an outline or organize thoughts, check grammar, or improve writing style with appropriate citation complying with Humboldt's Student Academic Honesty Procedure. You are responsible for fact checking statements composed by generative AI models and respecting intellectual property (sometimes it's just plain wrong!). Generative AI may not be used for composing discussion posts or completing assignments, writing papers/reports or portions of papers/reports for class assignments. If you are uncertain about the appropriate use of generative AI in this course, you are encouraged to contact your instructor for clarification. Inappropriate use of generative AI programs is not permitted and will be treated as plagiarism as defined in Humboldt's Student Academic Honesty Procedure and handled in accordance with the Procedure.

## Late Policies

For most assignments, there are no late penalties.

There are some exceptions to the late policy:

- Discussion Forums: Only earn maximum (extra credit) points for posts that are submitted ***before*** the due date. Fewer points are awarded as time goes on. See the discussion rubrics for specific details.
- Final Exam and the Final Project cannot be turned in late.

All late work must be submitted by the **Friday before final exams**. No late work will be accepted after **11:55 pm** on this day. Check the Canvas LMS for a specific day and time.

### Exceptions to the late policy:

Exceptions to the late policy will be made for:

- Students with compelling, life-threatening medical emergencies resulting in extended hospitalization (Documentation is required)
- Veterans and currently serving military personnel and spouses with unique circumstances (see details under course policies)
- Weather-related emergencies (see details under course policies)

## Extra Credit

At various time during the course, students *may* have the opportunity to complete extra credit assignments. However, there is no guarantee that extra credit assignments will be available.

Please remember that extra credit is a privilege, not a right.

## Incomplete Grade Requests

An authorized Incomplete indicates that a portion of required coursework has not been completed and evaluated in the prescribed time period due to unforeseen, but fully justified, reasons and that there is still a possibility of earning credit (Office of the Registrar). Incompletes are not a "fail-safe" for students who have neglected to submit sufficient work to pass the course. An incomplete will not be considered for students who have not completed a significant portion of the work up to the time of the circumstances justifying the incomplete. It is the responsibility of the student to bring pertinent information to the attention of the instructor, and to discuss with the instructor the terms of the incomplete contract.

# Additional Course Policies

## Academic Integrity

This course follows the Cal Poly Humboldt guidelines for academic integrity. Students are responsible for knowing the policy regarding academic honesty: **Academic Honesty Policy (http://humboldt.edu/studentrights/academic-honesty)** .

Academic dishonesty is a severe breach of trust upon which the success of this course depends. As such, this course maintains a **zero tolerance** policy for any violations of academic integrity. Students who violate the University's academic honesty policy will receive a failing grade in the course and may be held in violation of the University's code of conduct.

## Students with Disabilities

I am dedicated to helping accommodate students with disabilities, and I have designed this course with ADA compliance in mind. If there are additional disability-related accommodations needed, students should contact the Student Disability Resource Center in House 71, 826-4678 (voice) or 826-5392 (TDD). Some accommodations may take up to several weeks to arrange. **Student Disability Resource Center Website (http://www.humboldt.edu/disability)** .

**SDRC's Complete Policies and Procedures (https://disability.humboldt.edu/policiesandprocedures)**

## Names and Genders

The roster of students enrolled in this course are provided by the Office of the Registrar and include your name as it appears on your official Cal Poly Humboldt student file. This name, however, may not be the name by which you want to be addressed. Please advise the instructor of your preferred name or gender pronoun, as early in the semester as possible so you can be called by the correct name.

You can also update this system-wide. You'll find more background information and answers to frequently asked questions on the **Preferred Names & Pronouns (https://its.humboldt.edu/accounts-passwords/preferred-names)** page on the ITS website.

## Military Personnel

Veterans and currently serving military personnel and spouses with unique circumstances (4th, upcoming deployments, drill/duty requirements, disabilities, VA appointments, etc.) are welcome and encouraged to communicate these, in advance if possible, to the instructor in the case that special arrangements need to be made.

## Inclement Weather

In case of weather-related delays at the University, this online course will proceed as planned. Your instructor will inform you if there are any extenuating circumstances regarding content or activity due dates in the course due to weather delays. If you are affected by a weather-related emergency, please contact your instructor at the earliest possible time to make special arrangements.

## Attendance

The online version of GSP 270 is conducted entirely online. There will be no set class meeting times, but you will be required to complete assignments and quizzes each week.

## Assignment Due Dates

Always check the Canvas Learning Management System for specific due dates. Students may also check due dates using the interactive calendar in Canvas. Please be sure to track due dates carefully.

## Course Copyright

All course materials students receive, or to which students have online access, are protected by copyright laws. Students may use course materials and make copies for their use as needed, but unauthorized distribution and uploading of materials without the instructor's express permission is strictly prohibited.

Students who engage in the unauthorized distribution of copyrighted materials may be held in violation of the University's Code of Conduct, and liable under Federal and State laws.

## Disclaimer

Websites and other links may occasionally become unavailable, as is the fluid nature of the internet. While you should advise the instructor (by posting on Slack), it's in your best interest to search for alternate resources, should a link be broken, so that your progress is not delayed.

This syllabus is subject to change at any time, and you will be responsible for abiding by any such changes. Significant changes to the syllabus will be communicated to you via Canvas announcements.